

B1 Reading

New Generation English · Academic diagnostic

Reading

Why confidence is not the same as comfort

When Sofia joined an online English group, she expected the lessons to feel easier than school. She imagined that speaking from her room would be less stressful than speaking in front of classmates. The first lesson proved the opposite. Because the group was small, the teacher asked everyone to respond several times. Sofia knew many grammar rules, but she paused whenever she had to express a personal opinion.

After a month, she noticed a pattern. Her problem was not a lack of knowledge; it was the habit of waiting until a sentence was perfect. The teacher began giving tasks with time limits: thirty seconds to prepare, one minute to speak, and then a short correction. Sofia still made mistakes, but she became more willing to try. By the end of the course, she understood that confidence grows through repeated controlled difficulty, not through avoiding uncomfortable tasks.

Questions

1. What did Sofia expect before joining the group?
 - A. Online lessons would feel easier.
 - B. The teacher would ignore her.
 - C. There would be no speaking.

Answer: _____

2. Why was the first lesson difficult?

- A. Everyone had to respond several times.
- B. The internet failed.
- C. The text was too long.

Answer: _____

3. What was Sofia's real problem?

- A. Waiting for perfect sentences.
- B. Not knowing any grammar.
- C. Refusing to do homework.

Answer: _____

4. What kind of tasks did the teacher introduce?

- A. Timed speaking tasks.
- B. Only translation tasks.
- C. Silent reading tasks.

Answer: _____

5. What changed by the end?

- A. Sofia became more willing to try.
- B. She stopped making mistakes completely.
- C. She left the group.

Answer: _____

6. What does controlled difficulty mean here?

- A. A challenge with structure and support.
- B. A task with no help.
- C. An exam with no time limit.

Answer: _____

7. Which statement is closest to the main idea?

- A. Confidence develops through practice under pressure.
- B. Comfort is always the best learning condition.
- C. Grammar rules are unnecessary.

Answer: _____

8. What can be inferred about the teacher?

- A. The teacher used pressure carefully.
- B. The teacher disliked mistakes.
- C. The teacher avoided feedback.

Answer: _____